

INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGES

OVERVIEW

In courses in international languages, students develop their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills in order to communicate in the language of study (the target language) in a variety of contexts and for a variety of purposes, with a focus on real-life situations and uses. Through their exploration of a wide variety of authentic materials and meaningful activities, students develop not only language skills but also the skills necessary for lifelong language learning. They also acquire an understanding and appreciation of diverse communities around the world where the target language is spoken, and make connections to their own community.

Language structures and conventions that are appropriate for each level are listed in the Language Knowledge chart for international languages that is provided in Appendix B. Students should be given ample opportunities to demonstrate and extend their understanding of the language elements by applying them in a wide variety of contexts across the strands. Two additional charts are provided to assist teachers in planning learning activities – Topics for Developing Vocabulary, and Cultural Concepts for Developing Intercultural Understanding.

The expectations for courses in international languages are organized into four distinct but related strands:

Listening

Oral communication skills lay the foundation for the acquisition of any new language, and pave the way for learning to read and write in that language. Well-developed listening skills are essential for students' development of the proficiency in the target language that they will need to succeed in the program. To develop their listening and interaction skills, international language learners need extensive opportunities to listen to and interact with others. They also need to develop listening skills in order to understand what is said during classroom presentations, in radio and television broadcasts, and in many other contexts. At first, students listen to directions and instructions; as they progress, they are able to take point-form notes in class; and eventually, they are able to provide a summary of a presentation.

International language learners need many opportunities to listen to a range of subjects, including topics that interest them, concepts in school subjects, and contemporary issues. Students listen to words, phrases, and passages in the target language in order to identify standard pronunciation and to improve their reading comprehension. Students listen to explanations of language structures and conventions and cultural concepts. They also

listen to a wide range of oral texts representing formal and informal social registers and various genres and forms appropriate to their interests (e.g., podcasts, videos, song lyrics, radio shows, electronic sources, poetry, short stories, advertisements, video games, radio shows). They also need exposure to oral texts of increasing difficulty in the target language, such as longer radio broadcasts or documentaries on more complex topics.

It is important that teachers contextualize listening interactions and activities for students. This can be done through brainstorming to identify what students already know about the topic of a new text they are about to hear or view. Some examples of richly integrated tasks are: discussing strategies for organizing ideas for a writing assignment; presenting and defending ideas or debating current issues; and offering constructive and descriptive feedback about work produced by their peers.

Speaking

Oral language is a fundamental means of communicating with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Students build a broad range of speaking skills, both for conversational purposes and for academic purposes, such as presenting ideas and information to their classmates. At first, students engage in brief conversations on everyday topics; as they progress, they engage in speaking tasks such as sharing ideas about a variety of texts in a literature circle; and eventually, they are able to present classroom seminars or participate in debates.

International language learners need rich and frequent opportunities to speak and interact in the classroom in a purposeful way – for example, through collaborative learning in pairs and small groups that allows them to engage in speaking and listening for real-life purposes. Through multiple opportunities to speak in various groupings, students begin to communicate effectively and to gain confidence as they explore ideas and concepts, identify and solve problems, organize information, and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. An opportunity for self-reflection about their speaking skills and strategies enables students to strengthen their ability to express themselves and interact with other speakers of the target language.

It is important that teachers not only offer instruction and feedback, but also provide excellent models of the competence that a first-language speaker would demonstrate in speaking for both academic and social purposes. Teachers at all course levels should also provide modelling of various special sound features of the international language, and include instruction on norms and conventions associated with speaking the language in different cultures.

Reading

This strand provides extensive opportunities for students to build on their experience in listening to and speaking the target language to help them determine the meaning of written texts in the target language. Students read a wide variety of adapted and authentic literary, informational, and graphic texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. They activate their background knowledge, acquire vocabulary, think aloud about what they are reading, discuss texts with peers, and participate in group reading and learning activities. An effective reader not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the student must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts. The student can then understand, analyse, and absorb them and recognize their relevance in other contexts. The international languages curriculum develops the knowledge, strategies, and skills that will enable students to become effective readers in the target language.

As learners develop their reading skills in the target language, it is important that they have many opportunities to read a wide variety of texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary, become more attuned to the language structures and conventions of the target language in various genres, and increase their understanding of diverse world views.

Reading is a complex process that provides a bridge between speaking and writing. Students learning to read in the target language are also acquiring knowledge of new vocabulary and language structures, as well as a new phonological awareness of the sound system of the target language. Reading also involves the application of many comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading. Teachers need to model the use of such strategies, engage students in shared and guided exploration of texts, and foster the independent application of reading strategies. Students need to identify which strategies are personally most helpful and how they can use these and other strategies to improve as readers. For example, students might prepare before reading by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text and the vocabulary contained in that text.

During reading, students may use clues from context or from their understanding of language elements and structures to help them determine the meaning of unfamiliar words. They will also use a variety of comprehension strategies such as predicting, questioning, identifying main ideas, and monitoring comprehension to help them understand a text. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. For example, students might evaluate an author's perspective or bias in a piece of writing and discuss how that might affect the reader's interpretation.

To become fluent readers of the target language, students need to read frequently and develop the range of skills required to read for a variety of different purposes – to follow directions, to get advice, to obtain information, to build vocabulary, to obtain access to subject knowledge, and for personal interest and enjoyment.

It is important that students read a range of authentic materials illustrating the many uses of writing, since these texts will serve as models for texts that they will create. The reading program should therefore include a wide variety of literary, informational, fictional, and graphic texts – for example, short story, myth, legend, folk tale, poem, song, novel, play, report, newspaper or magazine article, television or radio script, manual, advertisements, autobiography, chart, diagram, graphic novel, comic book, recipes, and instructions.

Writing

From their experience with oral communication and reading, students acquire the skills they need to become good writers who are able to communicate ideas and opinions with ease and clarity. Current research confirms the similarity in the writing processes of both first- and second- language writers. The elements that go into writing in any language are essentially similar: selecting a topic; organizing and developing ideas to be included; choosing the form of writing and level of language appropriate to the audience and the purpose for writing; applying the conventions of written language such as grammar, spelling, punctuation, and word choice; and applying editing, revising, and proofreading strategies to produce a polished piece of writing.

However, for students who are learning a second language, the planning stage of the writing process is critical. Students must become skilled at choosing the correct vocabulary in the target language,

while selecting and organizing their ideas. They must also keep in mind the purpose for which they are writing and the audience they are addressing. To communicate clearly and effectively, they need to learn to use standard written forms and the language conventions of the target language.

Students who are beginning to write in the target language need to read a wide variety of texts that expose them to uses of vocabulary, grammatical elements, and idioms that they will need when writing their own texts. As students read a variety of written texts, they not only increase their vocabulary but also learn to vary their sentence structure, their organizational approach, and the voice they use in their writing. Students should produce a variety of forms or types of writing, such as descriptions, letters, journal entries, advertisements, brochures, summaries, reviews, dialogues, poems, short stories, questionnaires, newspaper articles, essays, and reports. Students should be given opportunities to produce interactive writing, different types of creative writing, as well as writing that addresses topics of interest to them and reflects their capacity for independent critical thought. Writing activities that are seen by students as meaningful and that challenge them to think critically and creatively will help them achieve a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing. Students' writing activities, in turn, support and reinforce both their oral language skills and their reading skills.

In addition, all students, whether they are writing in their first language or any other language, need to be taught ways to avoid plagiarism when writing for reporting and research purposes.

For more information about effective instruction in the four strands, consult the ministry resource document entitled *Adolescent Literacy Guide: A Professional Learning Resource for Literacy, Grades 7–12, 2013*.

International Languages, Level 3

University Preparation

LBADU – LDYDU

This course provides extended opportunities for students to communicate and interact in the language of study in a variety of social and academic contexts. Students will refine and enhance their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills, as well as their creative and critical thinking skills, as they explore and respond to a variety of oral and written texts, including complex authentic and adapted texts. They will also broaden their understanding and appreciation of diverse communities where the language is spoken, and develop skills necessary for lifelong language learning.

Prerequisite: International Languages, Level 2, University Preparation

A. LISTENING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. Listening to Understand:** determine meaning in a variety of oral texts in the target language, using a range of listening strategies;
- A2. Listening to Interact:** interpret messages accurately while interacting in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- A3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in oral texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

A1.1 Using Listening Comprehension

Strategies: identify a range of listening comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after listening to understand a variety of oral texts, including complex texts, in the target language (e.g., use their knowledge of the structure of different oral text forms to make predictions about the content before listening; use prior knowledge and contextual cues to make deductions and inferences while listening; formulate questions while listening to a presentation to prompt the speaker to provide more details; use organizers structured for their own learning styles to record key information while listening; compare interpretations of a speaker's message with a peer to confirm or expand their comprehension)

Teacher prompt: "What did you understand about the speaker's message that your classmate did not? What can he or she explain to you that you missed?"

A1.2 Demonstrating Understanding: demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and meaning of oral texts in the target language that contain information and ideas about a variety of topics, with support as appropriate (e.g., list language structures used to express emotions, desires, or opinions in a song or a poem read aloud; jot down the sequence of events in a peer's oral account of a childhood memory; infer the skills that an employer

requires and prioritize them after listening to a job description; summarize key ideas and outline supporting details in a documentary about an issue related to the environment, diversity, or First Nations, Métis, and Inuit peoples; describe what a movie reviewer enjoyed and why after listening to a radio show; identify the purpose of a variety of telephone messages; explain the pros and cons of ecotourism described in a radio documentary)

Teacher prompts: "What emotions did you hear expressed in the song? How were they expressed in its lyrics?" "What did the reviewer most enjoy about the movie? What did he or she describe as one of the most interesting traits of the main character, for example?" "Was the telephone message about business or recreation? Who was the speaker?"

A2. Listening to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 Using Interactive Listening Strategies:

identify and use a range of interactive listening strategies to suit a variety of situations while participating in social and academic interactions in the target language (e.g., use culturally appropriate body language and facial expressions to signal interest and acknowledge the ideas of others during group work; ask questions and offer constructive comments at appropriate points in an academic discussion to encourage other speakers to expand on their opinions; paraphrase different speakers'

points of view during a debate to verify their interpretations; affirm and build on the ideas of others during a class discussion)

Teacher prompts: “As you paraphrase what you heard, focus on key ideas. How might you explain your peer’s point of view in just one or two sentences? How does that help you determine whether you have understood?” “How might you affirm another speaker’s ideas during a class discussion?”

A2.2 Interacting: respond with understanding to what others say while participating in structured and open-ended interactions in the target language about a variety of topics, with support as appropriate (*e.g., respond to the ideas and opinions of others in a discussion about the influence of the media on social perceptions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit peoples; with a peer, improvise a friendly negotiation to extend a curfew or to revise house or school rules; after listening to a report on issues of importance to people with disabilities, identify concerns and share solutions with a peer; agree or disagree with others during a group discussion about learning other languages; ask questions in response to descriptive feedback from a peer or the teacher; after watching a video clip about an environmental issue, respond to the opinions of others in a small-group discussion about the causes and solutions; in a conversation with a peer, respond to questions about how financial support would help them pursue their personal and professional goals; answer a potential employer’s questions in a role play of an interview for an entry-level job in a country where the target language is spoken*)

Teacher prompts: “How has listening to the opinions of others about media influence shaped your own? How can you add to the ideas you have heard?” “What questions might you ask after getting feedback during a conference?” “What interview questions might you be asked when seeking work in another country? Which marketable skills might you wish to highlight?”

A2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after listening;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as listeners, and plan steps they can take to improve their listening skills (*e.g., during a student-teacher conference, describe how they self-monitor their use of listening strategies; keep a journal to track and reflect on progress towards personal goals to improve their listening skills;*

identify ways in which their learning environment may affect their listening comprehension; describe some types of body language they use to communicate interest to a speaker, and identify appropriate listening contexts for each)

Teacher prompt: “As you review your journal entries, what pattern can you identify in your use of listening strategies? What impact is that having on your progress in improving your listening skills? What might you do differently to reach your personal goals more quickly?”

A3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 Intercultural Awareness: using information from oral texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., explain how blending the target language and another language in a popular song contributes to its message; record key ideas presented in an authentic television program about indigenous cultures in a country where the target language is spoken, using a graphic organizer of their choice; after listening to a webcast, compile a list of questions and answers about a target-language community; role-play a situation that exemplifies gender roles or other social values in a target-language community, drawing on ideas found in an oral report; listen to readings about an historical event in Canada and an event in another country where the target language is spoken and identify points of similarity; listen to a documentary about environmental protection in Canada and in another country where the target language is spoken, and compare the approaches of the two countries*)

Teacher prompts: “How does learning about indigenous cultures help you respect their values?” “How do the gender roles of the target-language community differ from your own? How are they the same? How do they help you understand your own community?”

A3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

using information from oral texts in the target language, identify and demonstrate an understanding of sociolinguistic conventions used in a variety of situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., distinguish between regional dialects and identify variations in pronunciation and accent; identify*

and interpret non-verbal gestures that are characteristic of speakers in various target-language communities; identify speech conventions used in a target-language interview and compare them with interviewing conventions in their own first language; after listening to a target-language poem or short story, identify idiomatic expressions, colloquialisms, and proverbs; infer the relationship of speakers from their language register; analyse how the non-verbal interactions of characters in a target-language film clarify their spoken messages)

Teacher prompts: “What features of the speaker’s pronunciation helped you identify the region where he or she learned the target language? Were they strong or slight? What does that tell you?” “What do the non-verbal interactions of the movie characters tell you that their speech does not? How do their non-verbal cues support their spoken messages? How do they contradict them?”

B. SPEAKING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Speaking to Communicate:** communicate information and ideas orally in the target language, using a range of speaking strategies, appropriate language structures, and level-appropriate language suited to the purpose and audience;
- B2. Speaking to Interact:** participate in spoken interactions in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- B3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their spoken communications in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

B1.1 Using Oral Communication Strategies:

identify a range of speaking strategies and use them to express themselves clearly and coherently in the target language for various purposes and to a variety of audiences (*e.g., prepare guiding questions to pose during a group discussion; introduce the subject matter to their audience at the outset of a presentation, and summarize the essential points at the end; use rhetorical questions to engage their audience and to spark group discussions; adhere to time limits for presentations*)

Teacher prompts: “What information should you include in the introduction of your presentation to help your audience understand? What might you include in your summary?” “What kinds of rhetorical questions will engage your audience? Give some examples.”

B1.2 Producing Oral Communications:

produce planned, detailed, and spontaneous messages in the target language to communicate information and ideas about a variety of topics, with support as appropriate (*e.g., compose and deliver a public service announcement about an environmental issue such as energy conservation; give a eulogy for a historical figure; relate an embarrassing or a humorous moment; prepare and deliver a monologue explaining the connections between a picture and a personal interest; discuss the effectiveness of a target-language television commercial or film trailer;*

deliver a multimedia presentation on gender roles without notes; explain some challenges facing economic development in emerging economies in simple terms)

Teacher prompts: “Use the five Ws to decide what information to include in your public service announcement. How can you ensure that the announcement will tell your listeners everything they need to know?” “What visual aids might capture the interest of the audience for your presentation? Do they meaningfully support your topic?”

B1.3 Speaking with Fluency: speak with a smooth pace, appropriate intonation, and standard pronunciation in rehearsed, some detailed, and spontaneous communications in the target language about a variety of topics (*e.g., avoid awkward pauses by using familiar vocabulary to describe an idea or object when the exact term is forgotten; give clear information when face-to-face communication is not possible, such as in a telephone conversation; adapt their tone of voice and inflection to express irony, respect, and other attitudes in a conversation; recount a story or an event, varying their pace and pausing for dramatic effect; deliver a presentation with ease*)

Teacher prompts: “What can you do to avoid awkward pauses in your speech when you cannot remember the precise term you need?” “How can your tone of voice express different attitudes? Demonstrate with some examples.”

B1.4 Applying Language Knowledge: use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their meaning clearly in the target language

B2. Speaking to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 Using Conversation Strategies: identify and use a range of conversation strategies to suit a variety of formal and informal situations while participating in detailed spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., change the subject politely or suggest alternative topics for discussion; use body language, degree of physical proximity, gestures, level of assertiveness, and facial expressions to encourage others to join a conversation; agree with or politely challenge another speaker's opinion during group work; rephrase their message when the other participants in a debate have not understood; suggest a word or phrase to help a peer who is having difficulty communicating a spoken message*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some non-verbal ways to encourage others to join a conversation?” “How might you clarify your point in a debate when the other participants have not understood it?”

B2.2 Interacting: engage in structured and spontaneous spoken interactions in the target language about a variety of topics, with support as appropriate (*e.g., with a peer, discuss whether the message of a media text is persuasive; contribute to a round-table discussion about environmental and traditional practices in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities; with a partner, role-play negotiating a curfew extension; exchange opinions with a peer about a social issue such as mental health and well-being; in a group discussion, describe personal reactions to the setting, plot, and characters of a text the class is reading; defend a point of view in a debate about the use of technology in school; debate the usefulness of a cost-benefit analysis of an end-of-year event such as a formal dance or a graduation trip, using a graphic organizer for assistance; make plans with a partner about ways to fund gap year travel*)

Teacher prompts: “What elements of the media text held your attention? When did you feel distracted? What made the message persuasive or unpersuasive?” “As you express your opinion, consider whether it is objective or subjective. What supporting details might you use to defend your position?”

B2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after speaking to communicate effectively;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as speakers, and plan steps they can take to improve their speaking skills (*e.g., describe which speaking strategies contributed to a positive group discussion; identify the most effective elements of their oral presentation, and discuss what they would do differently next time; identify strategies they can use with a partner to improve mutual comprehension during interactions; plan to reflect on feedback from peers and the teacher on revising the form and content of their spoken messages*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies do you use to make a group discussion positive and successful? What makes them effective?” “What strategies do you find helpful to make yourself understood and improve your own comprehension during interactions?” “What kinds of feedback have you incorporated into your spoken messages? What other revisions might you make?”

B3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 Intercultural Awareness: communicate information orally in the target language about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., create a radio commercial highlighting the importance of learning additional languages; dramatize a scene that incorporates characteristics of a target-language community or its way of life; deliver a news report on target-language community initiatives; re-enact a significant historical event in a country where the target language is spoken; apply their knowledge of customs, attitudes, values, and beliefs in target-language communities to resolve an everyday conflict in a role play; deliver a presentation comparing and contrasting their own daily life with that in various target-language communities; create a podcast about an environmental initiative or project in a region where the target language is spoken*)

Teacher prompts: “What type of information can you include in your commercial to attract and educate your listeners?” “What aspects of daily life in the target-language community seem similar to your own? What things are different? How does this knowledge help you better understand and appreciate your own community?”

B3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use culturally appropriate verbal and non-verbal cues while negotiating solutions to problems, misunderstandings, and disputes; incorporate into a role play various colloquialisms and idiomatic expressions appropriate to the setting; use the appropriate level of formality to interact with people in various social contexts; identify and use some alternatives to standard vocabulary, such as regional, national, or dialect variations*)

Teacher prompts: “Is there a non-verbal cue you might use when negotiating the solution to a problem in one cultural context but avoid in a different cultural context? Why, or why not? What about a verbal cue?” “Why is it important to be aware of the social context when interacting with people?” “How do idiomatic expressions and colloquialisms help you better understand the target language and the cultures of people who speak it?”

C. READING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading Comprehension:** determine meaning in a variety of texts in the target language, using a range of reading comprehension strategies;
- C2. Purpose, Form, and Style:** identify the purpose(s), characteristics, and aspects of style of a variety of adapted and authentic text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms;
- C3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading Comprehension

By the end of this course, students will:

C1.1 Using Reading Comprehension Strategies:

identify a range of reading comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after reading to understand a variety of texts, including complex adapted and authentic texts in the target language, in various reading contexts (e.g., *preview the text for new words and predict their meaning; create mind maps in pairs before reading to activate prior knowledge and experience, and make predictions about the content; use their knowledge of word order to help them determine the meaning of a sentence; make connections to other texts to help them evaluate how effectively a text communicates its message; use visual cues to make inferences; create a list of questions to help them determine the author's intention or a character's motivation*)

Teacher prompts: “As you make a mind map, think about the connections between your knowledge and your partner’s. How can you illustrate those connections on your map? How do they help you get ready to read about the topic?” “How can reading ahead in a passage help your comprehension?”

- C1.2 Reading for Meaning:** demonstrate an understanding of information and ideas in a variety of texts in the target language, including complex adapted and authentic texts (e.g., *retell a story read in class from an alternative perspective; role-play various solutions to a conflict presented in a text; summarize the lesson of a target-language legend or fable, and compare the legend or fable*

with a similar one from a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit community; locate and record significant points in a newspaper article about a social or an environmental issue, and compose a rap or poem to express a personal reaction to the issue; interpret the instructions in a how-to manual; in a response to a blog, support or refute arguments presented in the blog about an environmental or social justice issue; after consulting government websites, outline the process of applying for a study or work visa for a country where the target language is spoken)

Teacher prompts: “How can you sum up the moral of this fable? What elements of the plot support this lesson?” “Which of the author’s arguments about this issue did you find persuasive? Why? Which parts did you disagree with? As you respond, remember to support your opinion by referring to relevant parts of the text.”

- C1.3 Reading with Fluency:** read texts in the target language at a sufficient rate and with sufficient ease to demonstrate that they understand the overall sense of the text (e.g., *smoothly articulate key words, such as academic or technical terms in a textbook, a report, or an essay; accurately pronounce new words while reading aloud; when reading a script aloud, use tone of voice, volume, emphasis, pauses, and pace to communicate the emotions suggested by a character's words and/or actions*)

Teacher prompt: “As you prepare to read aloud, think about the emotions that the character must be feeling during the scene. How can you convey them with your voice?”

C1.4 Developing Vocabulary: use a range of vocabulary-acquisition strategies before, during, and after reading to determine or confirm the meaning of new, unfamiliar, or recently learned words (e.g., *use knowledge of roots, prefixes, and suffixes from other languages to infer the meaning of unfamiliar words; consult a dictionary of idioms to clarify an unusual word usage encountered in a text; use knowledge of word order and parts of speech to infer the meaning of new words; keep a notebook of vocabulary related to various areas of interest for reference*)

Teacher prompt: “How is this word similar to the prefix, suffix, or root of a word from another language that you know? What does that tell you about its meaning?”

C2. Purpose, Form, and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 Purposes and Characteristics of Text

Forms: identify the purpose(s) and characteristics of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how the characteristics help communicate the meaning (e.g., *articles, graphics, and advertisements in a magazine appeal to a specific demographic; a play or movie script uses dialogue to develop the characters; information about the artist, the medium, and the artistic style on an exhibit plaque helps the viewer appreciate a work of art; impersonal style establishes the factual, objective orientation of a news report*)

Teacher prompts: “What elements of the magazine did you find appealing? How did they seem connected to your own experience?” “How does the information in this exhibit plaque help you interpret the artist’s message?”

C2.2 Text Features and Elements of Style:

identify features and stylistic elements of a variety of text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how they help convey the meaning (e.g., *figurative and descriptive diction in a poem, short story, or novel evokes an emotional response; stage directions further the plot in a play script; a table of contents, chapter or section divisions, headings, charts, labels, and captions organize the information in a textbook; logos, graphics, font sizes, and colour are used to draw attention to the features of the product in an advertisement to try to influence the behaviour of consumers; real people and events and accurate dates add credibility to historical fiction*)

Teacher prompts: “What effect does figurative language have on the reader?” “What kinds of stage directions did you find in the script?”

What was their purpose?” “How is your ability to interpret the messages in this textbook influenced by its textual elements and layout?”

C2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after reading to understand texts;
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as readers, and plan steps they can take to improve their reading skills (e.g., *keep a reading log to record texts they have read and identify ways of broadening their choices of reading matter; confer with the teacher and peers to develop new strategies for understanding challenging texts; in a journal, describe the benefits of reflecting on their reading practices and progress; review predictions made before reading to determine the effectiveness of this strategy; plan to vary their reading choices to expand vocabulary and increase fluency; identify and seek opportunities to read the target language outside the classroom*)

Teacher prompt: “What strategies do you use most consistently to help you understand new and challenging texts? What new strategies do you think would be effective?”

C3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 Intercultural Awareness:

using information from a variety of texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., *research symbols that represent a target-language community, such as a flag, particular colours, or a mascot, and explain their significance; research a ritual practised in a country or region where the target language is spoken, compare it with a ritual practised in a First Nations community, such as the naming ceremony, and share the information in an audio-visual presentation; interpret advertisements for events in various target-language communities to identify culturally significant practices; analyse the social and cultural context of a contemporary target-language play; read the words to various national anthems and describe how they do or do not reflect each country’s history or culture; identify additional languages required in authentic career postings in target-language communities around the world, and assess the implications for future course selections; identify and discuss differences between résumés in Ontario and in regions where the target language is spoken*)

Teacher prompts: “How does this symbol reflect the community it represents? What other symbol

might be appropriate?” “Which particular words or phrases in this national anthem are intended to highlight the country’s culture or history? Can you find similar words or themes in another anthem? How do the words reflect the unique characteristics of each country?” “What are the requirements of this career? How do you think those expectations might influence your future course selections?”

C3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify, in level-appropriate texts in the target language, examples of sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., skim newspaper and magazine headlines and advertisements to identify regional or idiomatic expressions and*

puns; compare the use of colloquialisms, idiomatic expressions, and slang in song lyrics or poetry from two different countries or regions where the target language is spoken; research idiomatic expressions related to money, and explain the contexts in which the expressions are used; compare two target-language print advertisements for the same product from different countries or regions, and identify similarities and differences in their language usage)

Teacher prompt: “In what ways do headlines reveal information that is specific to the region?”

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form:** write texts in the target language for different purposes and audiences, using a variety of forms and knowledge of language structures and conventions of the written language appropriate for this course;
- D2. The Writing Process:** use the stages of the writing process – including pre-writing, producing drafts, revising, editing, and publishing – to develop and organize content, clarify ideas and expression, correct errors, and present their written work in the target language effectively;
- D3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their written work in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1 Identifying Purpose and Audience:** determine, with minimal support from the teacher, their purpose for writing and the audience for texts in the target language they plan to create (*e.g., to depict a conflict between a superhero and a villain in a short graphic novel; to defend an opinion in a newspaper editorial or a film critique; to produce a biography that highlights the admirable qualities of a personal hero; to introduce themselves and the region in which they live to a potential exchange student by letter; to describe a significant Canadian historical event or person in a guide for newcomers to Canada; to defend animal rights in a letter to an organization that uses animals to test products; to express their viewpoint about an environmental or social justice issue, such as a project proposed on First Nations, Métis, or Inuit lands, in a letter to a politician; to outline in an application the attributes that make them suitable candidates for funding to support postsecondary study, work, or volunteering abroad*)

Teacher prompts: “What key expressions could reflect the different personalities of your superhero and villain?” “What phrases might enhance the authority of your opinion?”

- D1.2 Writing in a Variety of Forms:** write a variety of level-appropriate texts in the target language, applying their knowledge of various structural and stylistic elements of each form (*e.g., a report interpreting information in a graph or chart of census data for the target language; a cover letter to accompany a résumé; a summary of a journal, short story, or novel from an alternative point of view; a letter to the editor persuading youth to pursue language studies; a diary entry expressing a personal reaction to bullying; an essay about a social or an environmental issue*)

Teacher prompts: “What kinds of information could you include in your cover letter to convince a potential employer to read your résumé? How will you describe your skills without simply repeating the résumé? What is the ideal length for the letter?” “In your letter to the editor, what connections can you make between your point of view and your personal experience?”

- D1.3 Applying Language Knowledge:** use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their intended meaning in written work in the target language

D2. The Writing Process

By the end of this course, students will:

D2.1 Generating, Developing, and Organizing

Content: generate, develop, and organize ideas for writing in the target language, using a range of pre-writing strategies and resources, during modelled, shared, guided, and independent writing activities (e.g., *create a clear thesis statement and a list of points to support it; pose questions to guide research; gather supporting ideas and information from print and online sources; group point-form notes into main ideas and supporting details; organize ideas into a problem/solution pattern for a report about a current issue; determine the best structure, such as chronological order, compare and contrast, or cause and effect, for presenting information in a report or an essay*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you intend to prove in your text? How might you explain it in one sentence?” “Which of the following best describes the type of content of your essay: a sequence of events, the differences and similarities between two or more ideas, or the role of one event in causing another? With the content you’ve chosen, how might you structure your essay?”

D2.2 Drafting and Revising: plan and produce drafts in the target language, and revise their writing using a variety of strategies (e.g., *verify that each point in a draft is supported by sufficient information; match the structure and length of their sentences to the purpose of the text; improve the flow between paragraphs and between sentences by selecting words and phrases that indicate the logical transition from one idea to the next; refer to feedback from a peer conference to help them improve the coherence of their draft; write a short summary of their draft to help them evaluate its clarity and determine how to revise it further; add, delete, or reorder information to improve the clarity of their draft*)

Teacher prompts: “What effect does a series of short sentences have on the reader? Where in your draft might it be suitable to use this technique?” “Write a short summary of your draft. Is the message clear? If not, what should your next steps in revision be?”

D2.3 Producing Finished Work: make improvements to enhance the clarity and readability of their written work in the target language, and use a range of elements of effective presentation to produce a polished product for publication (e.g., *add organizational elements such as headings, a table of contents, or pull quotes to highlight key information; add a sidebar with definitions of*

unfamiliar terms; include quotations to support their ideas in an argumentative essay, and acknowledge the sources appropriately)

Teacher prompt: “What terms does your text contain that might be unfamiliar to your readers? How can you include definitions without disrupting the message?”

D2.4 Metacognition:

(a) describe a range of strategies they found helpful before, during, and after writing; (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as writers, and plan steps they can take to improve their writing skills (e.g., *select their best work for a writing portfolio and justify their choices; describe what makes an outline essential to the organization of a text; identify the self-correction techniques they find most useful when revising their written work and, in a personal reflection journal, comment on how they use them; describe the effectiveness of different resources they consult when correcting written work, such as peers, the teacher, parents, and print and online references; describe how exchanging ideas with a partner is effective as a strategy to improve their own writing; identify the benefits of planning carefully for each part of the writing process*)

Teacher prompts: “As you review your writing portfolio, what similarities do you find between the pieces of work that you consider your best? How does that discovery help you set new writing goals?” “Which self-correction techniques do you find most helpful when you revise your writing? Describe how you use one of them.” “When you exchanged writing ideas with a partner, how did your partner’s approach to the same topic differ from yours? How did the activity help you prepare for writing?”

D3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 Intercultural Awareness: in their written work in the target language, communicate information about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., *create a multimedia text about the history of indigenous peoples in a target-language community; write an opinion piece about an environmental or a social issue in a country or region where the target language is spoken; write a report on the effects of technology on a target-language community; analyse whether certain cultural customs*

of a target-language community reflect social bias, and explain their reasoning in an argumentative essay; write a welcome letter to a newcomer to Canada describing daily life in their community; create an ad campaign promoting a cultural celebration in a target-language community; create a brochure on sports in various target-language communities, describing how they are connected to national identity; write a persuasive text about the consequences of socio-cultural and economic disparity, making connections between Ontario and target-language communities and providing suggestions for more equitable distribution of resources; create a text that imitates the style of a major work of literature from a target-language community, such as an epic poem)

Teacher prompts: “As you prepare to write your opinion piece, consider the different possible points of view about the issue. What supporting details will corroborate your opinion?” “As you analyse this custom, consider the cultural context. How might culture affect how the custom is perceived?”

D3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in their written work in the target language (e.g., *compose a rap containing common target-language slang or colloquialisms; use the appropriate level of formality when responding to opinions stated in a blog about an environmental or a social issue; compare various target-language words or expressions that have more than one written form, such as national, regional, and slang forms, using a T-chart; create a multimedia text highlighting various regional expressions; produce a budget for a school committee using target-language number and currency formats; write a follow-up note to a potential employer after a job interview, using the appropriate language register*)

Teacher prompt: “Where can you find authentic target-language expressions to incorporate into your written work? How can you use them in a way that avoids stereotypes? How do these expressions expand your cultural explorations?”